Mary Barra

General Motors | Chair and CEO, since 2014

Meeting: First intro: earn a second meeting, Oct 16, 2026 | Prepared for: Founder / principal | Depth: standard | Sources: 8 of 12 source types, 19 cited | Status LIMITED | Prepared Oct 14, 2026

Take. Barra has run GM since 2014 [1], says AI writes nearly 90% of autonomy code [2], and reports results four days after you meet [3]. **Evidence:** GM raised its 2026 outlook in July [4]. **Action:** open on the 90% figure [2]. **Avoid:** asking her to forecast; "I'm done making predictions" [5].

QUESTIONS THAT CLOSE GAPS

1. **Anderson reports to Reuss** [6]**; who else weighs in?**
   Decides: who must say yes. **Ask:** Mary Barra.
2. **AI adoption "far exceeded" expectations** [7]**; which teams lagged?**
   Decides: where your offer fits. **Ask:** Mary Barra.
3. **Software margins beat hardware** [8]**; which line grows fastest?**
   Decides: her priority. **Ask:** Mary Barra.
4. **GM opens meetings with safety** [9]**; what must a tool prove?**
   Decides: the gate. **Ask:** Mary Barra, or the tool-approval owner.
5. **Eyes-off driving arrives in 2028** [10]**; which decisions need preparation?**
   Decides: urgency. **Ask:** Mary Barra.

WHO THEY ARE

- **Role:** Chair and CEO since Jan 2014 [1].
- **Path:** joined GM 1980 as co-op; Stanford MBA, 1990 [11].
- **The organization:** Fortune 500 No. 23, $185 billion revenue [12].
- **What changed:** Oct 2026, eyes-off driving set for 2028 [10]; Jul 2026, outlook raised to $14.0-16.0 billion [4].
- **Recent wins:** Jul 2026, Q2 EBIT-adjusted $3.9 billion, up 29.8% [13].

IN THEIR WORDS

- **AI at work, Fortune, Sep 10, 2026:** "It has far exceeded my expectations for how quickly people across the company" [7]
- **Predictions, Fortune, Oct 2, 2026:** "I'm done making predictions." [5]
- **Software, Fortune, Sep 10, 2026:** "Generally, software has better margins than hardware." [8]

LinkedIn: not read: file not given

SIGNALS AND WHAT TO DO WITH THEM

OBSERVABLE	WHAT TO DO WITH IT
Her priority: software's "better margins" [8]	Prepared leaders protect software growth.
Talyx preps executives [14]; GM's autonomy code is AI-written [2]	Leaders enter meetings prepared.
Results Oct 20 [3]; EV adjustments [15]	Ask for time after Oct 20.

BEHAVIORAL PROFILE

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	YOUR MOVE
Pace and control: "EVs are the end game" [16]	Match pace; propose once, then ask.
Appetite for detail: cites 700,000 vehicles [17]	Bring numbers and sources; allow silence after questions.
Appetite for risk: exited robotaxis [18]	Pair upside with safeguard in one sentence.
How they keep score: China share rank [19]	One peer reference helps; more is noise.

No read: How they take recognition · How they take disagreement

Evidence tier: medium: it sets how far page 3 goes

WHO DECIDES

- **Decision maker:** Not determined; Anderson reports to Reuss [6].
- **The gate:** Not determined
- **Relationship holder:** Not determined

STRONGEST CASE AGAINST

- **Against:** GM took $2.3 billion of EV adjustments, cutting net income outlook to $8.4-9.8 billion [15]; leaders may watch cost. **Reverses if:** she names a speed target for executive work.

MEETING ANGLE

A. This meeting

- **Frame:** AI adoption in executive meetings.
- **Lands:** her 90% autonomy-code figure [2].
- **Repels:** asking for autonomy dates [5].
- **What to bring:** one-page sample on public GM facts [14].
- **The ask:** 30 minutes after Oct 20 with her or the AI owner [7] · **Fallback:** the owner alone.
- **Stop if:** she says executive AI tools are off the agenda.

B. Meeting two

- **Meeting two:** 30 minutes after results [3] with the AI owner [7].
- **Meeting three:** trial with one GM executive team.

C. After the meeting

- **Capture:** who she names as AI owner.

EVIDENCE LEDGER

19 facts cited; status LIMITED at 8 of 12 source types. Dates: the source's own; 'seen' = the day it was read.

#	WHAT IT SAYS	SOURCE	GRADE	DATE
[1]	CEO 2014, chair 2016	gsb.stanford.edu	MEASURED	seen Oct 14, 2026
[2]	Nearly 90% autonomy code by AI	carscoops.com	MEASURED	Apr 30, 2026
[3]	Q3 results due Oct 20, 2026	investor.gm.com	DERIVED	seen Oct 14, 2026
[4]	2026 outlook up to $14.0-16.0B	sec.gov	MEASURED	Jul 21, 2026
[5]	"I'm done making predictions"	fortune.com	MEASURED	Oct 2, 2026
[6]	Anderson reports to Reuss	nbcsandiego.com	MEASURED	May 12, 2025
[7]	AI adoption "far exceeded"	fortune.com	MEASURED	Sep 10, 2026
[8]	Software margins beat hardware	fortune.com	MEASURED	Sep 10, 2026
[9]	Safety message opens meetings	fortune.com	MEASURED	Sep 10, 2026
[10]	Eyes-off driving planned 2028	fortune.com	MEASURED	Oct 2, 2026
[11]	Co-op 1980; Stanford MBA 1990	gsb.stanford.edu	MEASURED	seen Oct 14, 2026
[12]	No. 23 Fortune 500, ~$185B	fortune.com	MEASURED	Sep 10, 2026
[13]	Q2 EBIT-adj. $3.9B, up 29.8%	sec.gov	MEASURED	Jul 21, 2026
[14]	Talyx builds AI meeting prep	your saved setup	MEASURED	seen Oct 14, 2026
[15]	$2.3B EV adjustments, NI cut	sec.gov	MEASURED	Jul 21, 2026
[16]	"EVs are the end game"	fortune.com	MEASURED	Sep 10, 2026
[17]	700,000+ vehicles under $35K	fortune.com	MEASURED	Sep 10, 2026
[18]	Exited robotaxi; Cruise moved	fortune.com	MEASURED	Sep 10, 2026
[19]	Only Western maker up in China	fortune.com	MEASURED	Sep 10, 2026

Coverage	8 of 12 source types; not found: About page, posts, publications. LinkedIn: not read: file not given
Still open	• Decision maker: Who signs off on AI tools for GM leaders? • The gate: What must a new tool prove to GM? • Relationship holder: Who at GM carries this conversation afterward? • How they take disagreement: How does she respond when a plan is challenged?
Left out on purpose	health, family, politics, litigation, personal finances
Run	Oct 14, 2026 · standard · first intro · founder / principal · US · LIMITED · 6.3 facts per page

MEETING SCRIPT

Facts select the moves; read the room, never the record · Mary Barra, General Motors · Prepared Oct 14, 2026

1. OPEN

- **Hook:** *"Nearly 90% of your autonomy team's code is written by AI [2]. I'd like two minutes on what that could mean for how your leaders prepare."*
- **Credibility:** I'm with Talyx; we build AI meeting-prep and knowledge tools for executive teams [14].
- **Insight:** every fact in our briefs links to its public source, so safety-minded teams can check it [9].
- **Rule:** hold the 90% figure as the thread; return to it after each answer.

2. QUESTION ORDER

- **Story:** You said AI adoption "far exceeded" your expectations [7]; which teams have moved slowest?
- **Process:** Software has better margins than hardware [8]; which software line should grow fastest?
- **Gate:** GM opens meetings with a safety message [9]; what must a new tool prove to pass that bar?
- **History:** Eyes-off highway driving is planned for 2028 [10]; which executive decisions need the most preparation before then?
- **Commitment:** Sterling Anderson reports to Mark Reuss [6]; who else weighs in when GM adopts new AI tools?

3. OBJECTIONS: NAME IT, THEN ANSWER

- **"We build our own AI tools.":** *Your teams do, at nearly 90% of autonomy code [2]. I'm asking for 30 minutes on executive meetings, not a platform.*
- **"Results come out Oct 20; no time.":** *Understood [3]. I'd ask for 30 minutes after the call, with whoever owns AI adoption.*
- **"Data and safety come first.":** *Agreed; GM opens meetings with a safety message [9]. Every fact in a brief links to a public source.*

4. CLOSE

- **Restate:** ask what would make a second 30 minutes an easy yes, then say it back in her words.
- **Real deadline:** results on Oct 20 [3]; ask for a slot after that date.
- **The ask:** 30 minutes after Oct 20 with her or the leader who owns AI adoption [7] · **Fallback:** a 30-minute call with that leader.
- **Follow-up:** send a one-page sample built on public GM facts by Oct 21 [14].

5. READ THE ROOM (WATCH, DO NOT ASSUME)

- **Fast, wants the answer:** lead with the outcome in one sentence [16].
- **Asks for terms and data:** bring the figures and their sources [17].
- **Talks about people:** name the engineers behind the AI-written autonomy code [2].
- **Big picture, ideas:** link to 2028 eyes-off driving as the start of full autonomy [10].

6. IF IT STALLS

- **The move:** ask which teams got AI to write 90% of autonomy code, and what they needed [2].
- **The move:** ask how GM's robotaxi exit changed how it chooses new bets [18].

7. GUARDRAILS

- **Rule:** promise no results or dates for GM; claim nothing about its non-public plans.
- **Never say:** "Does that make sense?" · "Is this helpful?" · "No pressure" · "You'd know better than me" · "Just checking in"

Next step: send the one-page sample on Oct 21, the day after results [3].